

hands of Ivan Sutherland and his student Bob Sproull. After he was already successful and respected due to his revolutionary man-machine interaction program Sketchpad, Ivan visualised the concept of the “ultimate display” and began working on it with his colleagues at the Lincoln Library at MIT. The end result was a headset that could change the perspective depending on where you were gazing. Problem is, the device was so heavy that it had to be hung from the ceiling of the laboratory with a mechanical arm to be properly used in tracking the user’s head. Due to its formidable appearance, the device was named the Sword of Damocles.

Needless to say, that was far from real. There was little or no movements. the hardware they used was primitive, and VR wasn’t ready to let go off you. By 1980’s Virtual reality was gaining popularity thanks to its earliest pioneers Jaron Lanier. Lanier also founded VPL research, which went on

to make several VR devices like DataGlove, EyePhone and AudioSphere (somewhat like spiritual ancestors to GloveOne, Oculus and a yet to be popularised audio-vr respectively). The EyePhone, although much smaller than The Sword of Damocles, was still a hefty 2.4Kg. Imagine carrying your laptops around on your head.

In the 90s, not much was done to reduce this bulky weight from our shoulders. Virtuality launched and was one of the first controller based complete VR experiences that had a suitable catalogue of games to offer. Nintendo’s Virtual Boy was a massive failure, both due its poor ergonomics and sickening gameplay. Forte’s VFX1 brought a promising change in ergo-



Nintendo's VirtualBoy was its second least selling product ever.